

- **April 1861** At the outbreak of the Civil War, raises a volunteer company and is swiftly promoted to colonel and then brigadier general.
- **February 1862** His successful attacks on Fort Henry and Fort Donelson in Tennessee, with the capture of over 12,000 Confederate soldiers, win him praise and promotion to major general.
- **April 6-7, 1862** Almost routed at Shiloh, but retrieves the situation. His reputation is harmed by the high casualties suffered.
- **May-July 1863** Traps 30,000 Confederate soldiers at Vicksburg and forces them to surrender after a six-week siege.
- **October-November 1863** Taking command of the besieged Army of the Cumberland at Chattanooga, he wins a notable victory at Missionary Ridge (November 25).
- **March 1864** Promoted to general-in-chief of all Union armies with the rank of lieutenant general, Grant moves to the Eastern Theater to lead the fight against the main Confederate force, Lee's Army of Northern Virginia.
- **May-June 1864** Leads a Union advance through Virginia in the Overland Campaign, fighting Lee at the Wilderness, Spotsylvania, and Cold Harbor.
- **June 1864-March 1865** Fights trench warfare around Petersburg and Richmond, Virginia, wearing down the Confederate defense.
- **April 9, 1865** Accepts General Lee's surrender at Appomattox Court House, effectively bringing the war to an end; the terms allow Confederate soldiers and officers to return to their homes.
- **1869-1877** Serves two terms as president.
- **July 23, 1885** Dies at Mount McGregor, New York, of throat cancer.